

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Shameer Subedar

Address: 23 South Drive Cheam SM2 7PH

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: Re: Letter of Support - Planning Application DM2025/01591

Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub), involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Dear Planning Officer,

I am writing to express my strong support for planning application DM2025/01591. I am a local resident living within walking distance of the proposed site, and I believe this development would bring meaningful and lasting benefits to our community.

Accessibility and Local Need

As someone who currently travels to Sutton or the MCWAS (Carshalton) mosque to access appropriate faith facilities, I am acutely aware of the gap this proposal would fill. Having a facility of this nature within walking distance for myself and my family would be genuinely transformative, reducing the need to travel and making regular attendance far more practical.

Multifaith and Community Use

I strongly welcome the inclusion of a multifaith hall and function centre. This is not simply a single-use facility - it is designed to be open and welcoming to all members of the community. By making the hall available for hire and community events, the development actively encourages cross-community use and will help foster cohesion amongst residents of different backgrounds. The neutral and welcoming aesthetic of Option B's proposed façade further supports this ambition, presenting a building that is approachable and inclusive rather than exclusive.

Youth Provision

I particularly welcome the youth centre initiative included within the plans. Dedicated, accessible youth provision is something that is notably lacking in this area. I have three children, and this centre would give them a safe, structured environment in which to meet other young people from the local community - something that is genuinely difficult to find nearby at present. The fact that a community-led organisation is taking the initiative to provide this space, at no cost to the public purse, should be recognised and supported.

Provision for Women

I also welcome the dedicated activities and spaces for women included in the proposal. Accessible health, wellbeing and social programmes designed specifically around women's needs address a real demand in the local area and will provide an important resource for many residents who may otherwise lack access to such provision.

Educational Programmes for Children

The inclusion of educational programmes for children is another significant community benefit. Supplementary learning opportunities support children's development and help ease pressure on already stretched school resources.

Sustainable Travel and Parking

The proposal includes 12 on-site parking spaces and 2 dedicated disabled bays, which I consider adequate and appropriate for a community use of this nature. I am especially pleased to note the provision of generous cycle storage, which actively encourages sustainable travel. Given that the facility will serve many local residents who can walk or cycle, I do not consider traffic generation to be a significant concern. I am also reassured that Friday prayers are being staggered specifically to avoid conflict with school collection times - a thoughtful and considerate approach that demonstrates the applicants' awareness of their responsibilities to the wider neighbourhood.

Scale, Design and Greenery

The proposed building is modest in scale and in keeping with the character of the local area. Option B's façade is particularly well considered - refreshing and visually appealing without being overbearing. The retention of existing greenery is also to be welcomed and helps ensure the development maintains a pleasant relationship with its surroundings.

Alternative Uses and Pressure on Local Services

I would also ask the Council to consider what would happen to this site if the application were refused. There is a real risk that a vacant former ambulance station could be sold for residential development - potentially a large block of flats or additional housing. While I do not oppose housing in principle, our local services - schools, GP surgeries, community provision and transport - are already under considerable pressure. This proposal, by contrast, serves the existing community without adding to that pressure. It is a low-intensity use that gives something back

rather than simply adding demand.

I am satisfied that this development will not give rise to significant issues of traffic, noise or light pollution, and that the applicants have made every effort to be considerate neighbours.

I therefore respectfully urge the Council to grant planning permission for application DM2025/01591. This is a thoughtful, community-minded proposal that will deliver real and lasting benefits for residents across the local area, and I believe it deserves your full support.